

Washington County

Biss, Gregory R

EASTPORT

I have been following and supporting Shenna Bellows since her campaign for the US Senate in 2014. She spent an afternoon during that run at the Eastport Arts Center, where I was Board President at the time and her seriousness and smarts impressed us all. I have been a strong advocate for the program and attitude espoused by Graham Platner and believe that Shenna is the best choice for those intending to build upon that substantial groundswell of enthusiasm which Platner unearthed, and she thereby represents our best chance to unseat Susan Collins.

Brown, Diane

CHARLOTTE

I want to become a delegate because I am passionate about our democracy and want to have a candidate in the November election who can beat Susan Collins. I registered as a Democrat in 1974, so I remember when you could respect the Republican candidates. I have been a poll worker in Charlotte for over 20 years. I need to do all I can to make this nation a place where my grandchildren can thrive.

Chandler, Alden

EASTPORT

As your delegate I will support the candidate who commits to defeating Susan Collins by carrying out the issues from the Graham Platner campaign which energized so many of us. This is the right thing to do because it reflects the overwhelming will of primary voters. Moreover, we will not defeat Susan Collins without Platner voters. As a member of the Washington County Democratic Committee I will enthusiastically support the candidate as a volunteer and financially. On an ongoing basis I will devote time and resources to help strengthen the Maine Democratic party. About me: I am an openly gay retired man from Eastport, Maine. I had a 35 year career to 2008 as director of a state agency, the Maine Arts Commission, within six Democratic, Republican and independent administrations. As such I worked closely with the legislature and the congressional delegation on funding, policy and strategic cultural/economic development. From 2009–2019 I had an unplanned challenging but nonetheless rewarding caregiving career for three family members in California where I learned the healthcare system fast. I am a very active retiree restoring a 19th century sea captain's house, am a trustee of the LGBTQIA affirming UCC church, Machias and a board member of the Tides Institute & Museum of Art. I chair the Eastport National Register Central Historic District Committee and previously did fundraising as a volunteer for a social justice organization, an organic farm and local history projects. I

graduated high school in Maine and from Colby College. I have
LGBTQIA+

Clark, Harold R Jr

CALAIS

As a small business owner of 30 years and a disabled union worker, I live the realities facing rural Maine every day. I am running to serve as a delegate because our communities need a fierce advocate who understands firsthand the desperate need for accessible, affordable healthcare in our rural towns. We cannot afford the status quo any longer, which is why my central mission is to help defeat Susan Collins this November. To win, we must flip the script in areas that feel left behind. My strategy to defeat Collins relies on targeted local mobilization. I plan to leverage my deep roots in Washington and Hancock counties to organize and mobilize fellow small business owners, laborers, and neighbors who are ready for change. These two counties are vital to a statewide victory. By activating the local business community, we will build a resilient coalition that drives historic voter turnout. Building on our party's grassroots momentum means meeting people exactly where they are—in union halls, main street shops, and rural communities. I will use my unique background bridging the labor and small business sectors to unite voters who might otherwise feel disconnected from the political process. By fostering direct, peer-to-peer conversations about the issues that impact our daily survival—like healthcare access and rural infrastructure—we will expand our grassroots network from the ground up, keeping this momentum alive through November and well into the future.

Coley, Sussan

EASTPORT

I believe Dr. Shah is a genuine, decent, dedicated individual who can serve our state of Maine (his constituents) to the fullest extent of the laws and regulations. He helped us during Covid, is a subject matter expert as a provider. We need him to fight for us in so many fronts to make it affordable and fair for all of us. He is man of integrity and honor, which we need mostly.

Dunbar, Kathleen

EASTPORT

I would like to serve as a delegate because I think it's very important to defeat Susan Collins and I would feel honored to be part of the important process of choosing her opponent. I went door to door for the Platner campaign and would be happy to do it again for whomever is chosen to fill his spot on the ballot. It's important to put a democrat in the senate who will represent all Mainers.

Eaton, Sharen

EAST MACHIAS

I joined the Platner Campaign in February phone banking and knocking doors in Lubec, Eastport, Perry and Machias. Knocking doors was not just determining whether someone supported Graham, it was having extensive conversations with neighbors about what they needed, wanted and believed. The desperation in places was palpable and Graham's platform resonated with almost all of the people visited. One of the questions asked was, "What can this candidate do to make your life better?" I want to see a candidate elected who will continue asking that question. Graham's platform was based on: healthcare as a human right; housing affordability; an economy that works for regular people, not billionaires; strengthening workers and unions; ending forever wars and opposing complicity in atrocities; human rights for all, including tribal sovereignty and immigration reform with an end to mass deportation enforcement; and energy and climate accountability. I continue to stand behind this platform and will expect nothing less from a candidate. The well-being and freedom of our country depends on it. We need to and will flip this Senate seat and I will do everything in my power to make that happen. Graham's campaign had a rigorous schedule and amazing strategy building momentum and we are already losing time. I am eager to get back to connecting with neighbors, knocking doors and saying goodbye to Susan. Thank you for your consideration.

Farrell, Landen

LUBEC

I believe I represent a younger voice in Maine politics, a voice that is often overlooked and underrepresented. Leading up to this November I plan on having difficult conversations with peers and strangers, as well as joining the campaigning team for the new democratic candidate for senator. I believe actively participating in politics is something that is necessary for a functioning democracy, and if I want what's best for my state and my country not only do I but everyone around me needs to take initiative to build a brighter path forward. I realize this movement does not end after this election, but I believe it can live and continue on in the conversations and minds of people across the state, even after the election I want to inform myself and other on how to keep being engaged in state and local politics.

Fleischman, Mark Alan

LUBEC

Dear Fellow Maine Democrats, We are at a defining moment for our state and our country. As we gather for this special convention to select our next nominee for the United States Senate, we need delegates who understand both the heart of grassroots organizing and the modern tools required to win tough campaigns. For the last six years, I've been proud to call Lubec home after moving here from Bangor, giving me a deep appreciation for both our state's cities and our vital rural communities. My entire adult life has been dedicated to the labor movement and the fight for economic justice. I

know firsthand the power of collective bargaining, and I believe fiercely that every worker deserves the protection, dignity, and fair wages that come with a union. In 2015, I founded Action Network—a non-profit born out of the need to give working-our progressive movements the digital tools to fight back against big-money interests. Today, it stands as a leading provider of tech services to the DNC, the labor movement and progressive organizations nationwide. I’ve spent the last decade building the literal infrastructure of our party’s victories. As your delegate, I will cast my vote for a Senate candidate who will champion: Economic Justice: Rewriting the rules of our economy so rural and working-class Mainers aren't left behind. Unions for All: Protecting and expanding the right to organize in every sector. Single-Payer Health Insurance: Guaranteeing healthcare as a fundamental human right, not a corporate privilege. I bring a unique

Freeman, Reneen S

MILBRIDGE

I would like to participate in being a delegate to help make sure Maine peoples priorities are met and that we are not just going to push through any candidate to fill the spot, I truly believe the grass roots campaign that was started needs to be acknowledged and expanded if we are to beat Susan Collins. I will offer my time helping in any way I can during this process from posting on social media to hosting candidates in our area or just talking to people one on one.

Frewen, Peter

EASTPORT

I am an old man, which probably disqualifies me already. So, I start with that. For the past dozen and more years, I have been investigating what is it that defines the “Greatness” of America. The astonishingly simple answer, I have concluded, is, “We are, We the People.” But, of course, nothing is ever that simple. It turns out, We are also the problem. “We have met the enemy, and it is us!” The public Declaration 250 years ago was the assertion by a society of persons, that human beings are born politically equal, neither master nor servant. They require no authority but their own collective free will to join into a political community by their own accords. The principal political leaders of that day shared a philosophical equanimity to take people as they are. “The human person falls short of the ideal.” We are all fallible, all corruptible. Government, formed to secure the inalienable personal rights within a politically equal society, must be so structured as to educate the fallible and to stifle the corrupt. We speak of government as a thing, an “it”. When it doesn’t perform well, we say it is broken, needs fixing. But government manifests through the decisions and actions of human beings, fallible and/or corruptible human beings. Step 1 requires communication among ourselves, to select honorable, principled, knowledgeable individuals for the job; which, step 2, requires their independence of thought as well as a collegial capacity. I offer myself to assist in step 1.

Gay, Melanie Marie

CHERRYFIELD

My name is Melanie Gay, I grew up in Cherryfield Maine on a dairy farm that is now been turned into a Horse Farm that I have run for the past 25 years. I am a single woman and a business person and politics has been part of my life forever. Graham Platner is the most exciting thing that I've seen come along, and I am devastated at how his campaign was taken down. I hope he sues! But that's not where we are now, we have to get someone elected that can defeat Susan Collins, the energy that his campaign brought to the state of Maine was unprecedented. I would like very much to be a delegate to go to Bangor on the 25th it's also my 71st birthday. I will be in Machias whatever day they find the meeting spot before that. Thank you for your consideration Melanie Gay.

Gibson, James Russell Jr

ALEXANDER

Now is the time. Now, more than any point in our past, it is time to reshape our political future. Now is the time to redraw the landscape of our government. One that reflects the values of working families. One that protects our seniors so that they can live life with dignity. One that protects workers rights. One that protects the right for women to control their own health decisions. It's well past time to strip the power and influence that corporations hold. We need a government that reflects the populace. Our future is now. It's time to seize the moment and carry this momentum through November and beyond. I was involved with my local union. I chaired our COPE committee, worked with the AFL-CIO on many campaigns including Mike Michaud's. I have testified in Augusta on many worker and trade related issues in the past. Knocked on doors. Grassroots is the most powerful tool we have. Let's all join together, work for the common good. We have the power to turn the tides of injustice. Now Is The Time!!!

Giero, Richard Anthony

PERRY

Yes, I can attend the Nominating Convention on 25 July. I am retired from the Army and civil service. There is no more important event for me to attend this convention.

Disability

Gordon, Gretchen

PEMBROKE

I've spent the last nine months working for the Platner and Dunlap campaigns in Washington County--door-knocking in Calais, Eastport, Pembroke, Perry, and Machias, plus tabling, texting, and sign delivery--starting with Graham's October 2025 Calais town hall and continuing through the

Eastport Fourth of July parade. I saw firsthand the scale of energy the Platner campaign built, especially among unenrolled voters. As a delegate, I want to help ensure whomever we nominate can honor and hold on to that coalition. Shenna Bellows would be my first-round choice: she pairs a peoples' platform with the deep resume needed to unite progressives and attract the broader coalition required to defeat Susan Collins in November. To help win this crucial seat, I'll keep doing what I've been doing: canvassing and organizing so that no vote in our county is taken for granted. Once our nominee is chosen, I'll put my full energy behind both of Maine's federal candidates in a year when the results are existential for our democracy. I'm also part of groups organizing to hold our next Senate nominee accountable to the platform that drew so many new and unenrolled voters into this movement--that has to survive, regardless of who carries it forward. Locally, I'll work to rebuild and expand the volunteer infrastructure that galvanized around Graham Platner, uniting people around the shared goal of removing Susan Collins, whatever their feelings about the last few tumultuous months.

LGBTQIA+

Grubel, Margaret

LUBEC

I live in a fishing village of 1200 people. Rural voters have often been left out of the conversation in elections. I would be honored to help select a candidate for the Senate who will represent all parts of Maine. Rural areas have unique challenges, but they also have important strengths (how they come together to help members of their community regardless of party affiliation). I and two other women are presently leading a postcard campaign for Washington County, focusing on those Democrats, Republicans, and Independents who have not voted in the last two elections. The postcards will have prints of hand painted scenes of various Washington County towns and brief hand written messages telling these potential voters why we are voting Democrat. We plan to send out two to three batches of these postcards before the general election. These will be paired with hand painted signs highlighting similar messages. This method has proven to be effective in a rural New Mexico district, and we believe it will be effective here in Washington County. We think we can help bring the 'moveable middle' over to vote for Democrats. Building on community ties, I am confident our project will be one campaign piece to help successfully topple Susan Collins. What we've learned from those involved in turning New Mexico CD2 from red to blue (and keeping it that way) is that these campaigns don't stop in off-election years. We intend to continue to build upon this.

Hinerman, Michael F

MACHIAS

I want to help ensure that the next senate candidate selected at the convention is the most capable to beat Susan Collins in November. I'm willing to work together with fellow democrats to weigh the pros and cons of each candidate to achieve this. Graham Platner laid the groundwork let's finish this.

Howell, Peter M

LUBEC

How did we get here? - not really important at this time. What do we do now? - this is where our attention is needed. We have an important task, to select a candidate who can defeat Susan Collins in the Senatorial election and who would also serve well in the U.S. Senate to support a rational agenda and to conduct the nation's business. Although I currently hold opinions of who would be a good selection, I would listen to the ideas and commitments of all the potential candidates and select from among them with care and consideration. I have participated and provided infrastructure support for the Washington County Democrats and I have been active in Lubec town municipal committees. I also serve with the Lubec Fire Department and work as an EMT providing emergency care in the area. Peter M. Howell Lubec, Maine

Jones, Mcginley

LUBEC

As a Mainer in Washington County I have witnessed my small town of Lubec Loose it's year round businesses including our Nursing Home and our High School, our rural health center is now a skeleton of what it was in the late 80's early 90's. Our two rural hospitals serving an area that is over a 3 hour drive end to end, have been downgraded to critical access, and are down to just 1 maternity ward to service the entire County. Cancer patients have a 6 hour round trip drive to Bangor and back to get their treatments. I am an employer in and have once again lost my health Insurance because I can no longer afford the premium. We are spending literal Billions in Iran and Gaza and Venesuela, on Trump's Plane and reflecting pool and ICE agents, who are killing people on our streets. I want to be a delegate so I can vote for change. Vote for a progressive candidate who will Create affordable housing, Restore our health Insurance, environmental protection regulations, and Veteran's care and services, Protect Social Security and Medicare, Empower unions and civil servants, Assist students with their education including trade schools. And Impeach, Remove and Convct the corrupt members of our current Government and End Billionaires ability to buy our elections. We need to put our tax dollars back into the people who pay the taxes. As Mainers, Americans, and Human Beings, it's our right to expect and demand better.

Kuhns, David

MILBRIDGE

Please consider my application for a delegate to the Maine Democratic Convention. I'm a proud USAF veteran of the Vietnam era, a retired Physician Assistant, having practiced emergency medicine in Maine ERs from York to Portland to Bangor. I've been a registered Democrat for the 40+ years I have lived in Maine. I want our elected representatives to properly address the social and financial inequities that our neighbors in Washington County face daily, ranging from feeding needy children, to providing supplemental heating assistance for our elderly neighbors. I too have flinched as I watch

the cost of groceries continues to rise. Likewise, when I go to fill the tank in my nine year old Subaru. I'm alarmed when I see the dramatic increase in the number of Mainers who can no longer afford to pay their property taxes and water/sewer bills. I'm absolutely committed to helping our candidate defeat Susan Collins, as first and foremost, as she has helped Trump to destroy the things that I hold precious; the right to a fair and balanced elections. The right of women to decide for themselves if and when they might chose to be a mother. Quality healthcare for all, especially for America's veterans, is a priority for me, as is making sure that rural Maine is adequately served by well staffed and equipped hospitals. Lastly, I'm appalled by the reckless tactics of ICE and the pain that they have inflicted on so many. Respectfully, David Kuhns, Milbridge

Lander, Laura L

MACHIAS

I would like to serve as a grassroots delegate to help fill the complement of everyday citizens being given a voice in this unique process. I am also working on repurposing yard signs and postcard campaigns to help inform non-involved voters of all persuasions that it will be in their best interest to vote Dem this Nov.

Larochelle, Ronald

CHARLOTTE

This spring, I heard Graham Platner speak when he visited Calais. I immediately recognized that he had abilities that I've found lacking in other former Democratic hopefuls. More recently, I was heart broken to learn that Platner had disqualifying character flaws. Fortunately, Maine has a reserve of good candidates who can fill the Senate position. I trust that none of them would feel compelled to vote to please a rogue president at the expense of the citizens of Maine.

Lavender, Linda

ROQUE BLUFFS

Maine needs a senator that is invested in helping Maine residence a candidate that is focused on the issues that many struggle with grand Platner voiced those issues and now we need a candidate that will continue to carry the torch on these very important issues I had already volunteered at events for grand Platner. I continue to be interested in participating and canvassing.

Lavoie, Denise H

CHERRYFIELD

Defeating Susan Collins is the most important task for us. She has voted to erode our democracy many times. She has proven that her personal interests and her favor in the Republican Party outweigh her service to the people of Maine. Our country is in grave danger and we must do all that we can to stop the corruption and destruction. Removing Susan Collins is the fight we must fight. I have been a registered Democrat my entire life. Voting is a privilege and duty. I want to do everything I can to fight for our Democracy. We may not get another chance. We must show the people of Maine who Susan Collins truly is. We must show the people of Maine that our Senate candidate will fight for the needs of all Mainers. The way to get votes is to truly understand what Mainers need and show them we will fight for it.

Lemire, Genevieve

PEMBROKE

I am interested in being a delegate to participate in the selection of the candidate that will have the best chance of defeating Susan Collins in November. I have been part of the grassroots senate campaigning effort for 10 months, working to reach as many voters as possible in Washington County. I have been listening to and talking with the voters, hearing their needs and wants for themselves and for our state. This has given me a well-informed idea of who they are looking for in a senator. Going door to door in the last 4 or 5 months I have heard what voters are looking for in a candidate. I want to help the Democratic Committee select the person who best meets the needs of our communities, the state, and has the ability to win the election. I worked as a quality analyst in aerospace for over 40 years and have a specific skill set in following facts that result in solutions to overcome short- and long-term issues. Being a candidate for the Maine House of Representatives for District 10 in 2026 I will be meeting voters during my door-to-door canvassing. This will provide me with an opportunity to listen to voters and promote the state senate candidate that is selected going forward.

Lerwick, Patricia A

MILBRIDGE

I would like to serve as a delegate to the nominating committee, because I can no longer watch the failed policies of our government without being part of the movement to reclaim it and make it work for Mainers, rather than billionaires. I have seen, as a physician, how lack of access to affordable health care has devastating consequences for patients and families. Senator Collins has health insurance, but thousands of Mainers don't and won't, thanks to her critical support of Trump's One Big Beautiful Bill. While Collins has become a millionaire, 20% of children in Washington County live below the poverty line. While our government pours money into a needless war, Mainers are struggling to get by, choosing between buying their meds, feeding their kids, or filling their gas tank. Too many in

Washington County are struggling to find adequate housing, with increasing numbers unable to pay their property taxes or sewer bills, while Trump has become a billionaire thanks to unprecedented government corruption. Immigrants in our communities are being terrorized and attacked by ICE agents, thanks to Collins's deciding vote to give additional funding to ICE. Enough. We need a Senator who will work to feed kids, fund health care, improve access to housing, and fight for working class Mainers and against a corrupt administration. I will continue outreach to friends and contacts throughout the State, advocating for election of the Democratic Senatorial candidate and volunteering for whatever tasks the campaign needs to win and defeat Susan Collins.

Morrison, Patricia Leona

MEDDYBEMPS

As a 40-something parent of small children, business owner, and nonprofit co-founder, I have a lot of investment in the future of Maine, especially our rural DownEast area. My degree is in Peace & Global Studies, a mixture of politics, international studies, and the history, theory, & practice of nonviolent social movements. I have training and experience in education, activism, facilitation, mediation, & organizing. I look forward to helping defeat Susan Collins and protect our democracy and our neighbors by putting this background to work. The people of Maine have so much more in common with each other and the values of this grassroots movement than we do with billionaires and autocrats. It is vital that we come together to see each other as neighbors again, to truly take care of each other, and to elect candidates who advocate for and support that.

Immigrant/New Mainer

Nichols-Goodliff, Elizabeth

EAST MACHIAS

Hello, my name is Elizabeth Nichols-Goodliff, Beth Goodliff for short. I am a teacher and also work part time as a CNA at the Machias Veterans Home. I am willing to serve as a delegate or an alternate if needed to support a candidate for Maine's Senate race to defeat Susan Collins and bring some accountability to Washington D.C for Maine and our country. We need to find a way to recapture that energy that we all responded to with the town hall meetings and the social media. We need to find a way to reach the people who don't vote, who don't pay attention to politics using social media, podcasts, events and engagement. My idea of a candidate who could defeat Susan Collins would be a person who is from Maine. They should have experience in Maine government. They should not have already lost a head to head election against Susan Collins. They should not take money from outside interests groups that support genocide. They should not be in their 70's or 80's. They should be in favor of a living wage, affordable healthcare and housing. They should support our community and fight for children's education funding, taking care of our seniors, and our working class. They should be staunch allies of our LGBTIQ+ population and be supported by local Maine unions. If they were also endorsed by Bernie Sanders and held progressive ideals that would be the ideal person I would support to run for Senate.

Ouellet, David T

ADDISON

I would like to serve as a delegate to the State Nominating Convention. It is vitally important that our nominee be the strongest candidate able to retire Susan Collins. We need to elect a candidate that will fight to stop Trump's illegal power grabs. Our next Senator must support Medicare for all, tax increases for the wealthy and big corporations, ending Trump's illegal war, reigning in ICE and DHS, demand more funding for domestic programs, strengthen Social Security, and advocate for a more progressive Democratic Party. In the past I have volunteered at our county's campaign office, done canvassing, and collected signatures for RCV and local candidates. I have been a delegate at state conventions in the past. I believe a delegate should vote for the candidate that has the greatest support at the County Nominating Convention.

Pancoast, Taylor A

STEUBEN

I am running to be a delegate because defeating Susan Collins in the general election in November is essential for the safety and security of this country. I appreciate this opportunity to participate in the democratic process and will take my responsibility as a voting delegate seriously.

Plummer, Scott

MEDDYBEMPS

For six years, I was part of the Southern Oregon Democrats' executive committee and also the chair of the Platform and Resolutions committee. It was good fun and good for the community to be involved in the decision making process. Our committee helped galvanize statewide support for many progressive causes including ranked choice voting, legalization of psilocybin, uniform rules for legislative walkouts, and changes in mental health responses. While a biotech entrepreneur, I managed many relationships with potential collaborators, government agencies, and multinational companies both in this country and in Europe, so I am fond of listening and finding common ground.

Preston, Victoria

PRINCETON

I have traveled over our state for the last thirty years. As a retired Maine Family Planning consultant to schools and communities, I have heard and can share what people want and need from their representatives on both the state and national level. The candidate that is chosen to run against Collins must be ready to jump in with a solid platform on what they will do to increase access to health care, address food insecurity and housing, a plan to save the Main Streets in our state while attracting businesses that align with our values and protection of our natural resources, honor the Constitution,

protect reproductive rights, support and protect immigrants who have made Maine and the country their home. The retelling of the many ways Collins has let Maine and the nation down takes time and money away from what the new candidate offers. I have participated in phone banks, door knocking, and am ready to use my public speaking talents to defeat Collins. I have volunteered to register voters and count ballots in my town of Princeton. It would be an honor to attend and participate at the Nominating Conference.

Reilly, Eileen

CRAWFORD

I am 79 years old and I serve as the Managing Attorney for Next Step Domestic Violence Project which provides services to survivors of domestic violence, sexual assault, and human trafficking. In this capacity I work closely with Mainers in both Hancock and Washington counties. I believe we need drastic change and I am not willing to just sit back and let others do the heavy lifting. I have the energy, integrity, courage and determination to see this unprecedented process through in a way that leads to success in November and would be honored for the opportunity to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Commission.

Reynolds, Jeffery

JONESPORT

I'm a lifelong Democrat and progressive, born and raised in Maine, and believe my policy preferences align most closely with those Mainers voted for on June 9th. I'm also able to find compromises and not let the "perfect" be the enemy of the good.

Rule, Denise D

LUBEC

As a delegate, I would look to candidates who are willing to continue the grassroots movement of empowering the people of Maine to participate in the governing of their Town, their State, and their Country. To remind them of Abraham Lincoln's words in the Gettysburg Address, "...a government of the people, for the people, by the people..." This is their right, privilege, and obligation to make it happen. I would look for a candidate who does not accept money from AIPAC, big corporations, special interests, or foreign governments. I was a supporter of Graham Platner's movement and want the momentum to continue. I feel that I am qualified to be a delegate and to nominate a candidate, given my membership and participation in the Washington County Democratic Committee over the past 10 + years, my involvement in the Town of Lubec as a Budget Committee member, Board of Appeals member, and as a former member of the Economic Development and Recycling Committee, and as a regular ballot clerk. I am also an active member of the Lubec Woman's Club, a supporting member of the Lubec Garden Club, a volunteer Chair Yoga instructor at the Lubec Outreach Center,

and a former long-term volunteer at the Lubec Fitness Port, as a yoga teacher, senior exercise instructor, and front desk representative.

Sazer, Shelley

INDIAN TWP

I am a life-long registered Democrat from a family with a history of labor union and political engagement. I am a strong advocate for the democratic process, fair elections, voter participation and protection. While I am disappointed that due to current extenuating circumstances there will not be a primary election to choose the Democratic candidate for US Senator from Maine, I appreciate the extraordinary effort that has led to the convention process in which I am privileged to participate. My strong preference is for Dr. Nirav Shah to be the next Senator from Maine. However, I pledge to vote for the consensus candidate selected at the statewide convention and will urge all Maine voters to do the same. The most important thing we can do is defeat Susan Collins in November. Like many Maine people, I first became familiar with Dr. Shah during the pandemic, when he was Director of the Maine CDC. What most impressed me was the way he shepherded us through those uncertain times by educating us and answering our questions. Then, as Principal Deputy Director of the US CDC, Dr. Shah navigated US Government bureaucracy and politics to improve the wellbeing of the country. His public health, medical, scientific, and legal skills, along with his experience in national politics, distinguish him from the other candidates in this race and will serve him, and us, well in the US Senate.

Shomler, Zachary

CALAIS

Over the past 11 months, I have devoted more than 1,000 unpaid volunteer hours to defeating Susan Collins and building a stronger Democratic Party in Washington County. Before leaving my job to joining the Platner campaign as its communications manager, I served as the campaign's volunteer leader in the county, organizing events, recruiting volunteers, knocking doors, making calls, and helping engage voters across the county. I am seeking to serve as a delegate because the incredible grassroots energy we've built over the past year cannot be allowed to divide and fizzle out. I believe I am in a unique position to speak on behalf of the 77% of democratic primary voters of those who backed a progressive, working class platform, and to ensure that we select a candidate who will carry on the torch of our movement. Regardless of the circumstances they have brought us here, my focus remains exactly where it has always been: defeating Susan Collins in November, and ensuring that the working people of Maine have a real voice in our governance. I will continue to use the contacts and resources at my disposal in organizing, communicating with voters, recruiting volunteers, and doing whatever is needed to elect our Democratic nominee to the U.S. Senate.

Sloan, Michael Lloyd

JONESBORO

I am a lifelong moderate Democrat with loads of perspective from travelling and living across the USA, and participating in our local, state and federal election process as a volunteer. We need to beat Susan Collins this fall to help ensure that the Senate falls under Democratic control. I am able to attend and serve as a delegate if chosen, and would be proud to serve Washington County Democrats. Go Blue!!! Maine needs great leadership and I want to make sure that any Senate candidate we put forward to the general election always has 'Is it good for Maine?' as a core value. This election and the next Presidential election may be the two most important of my lifetime, as we strive to protect and preserve the ideals that have made America a country to proud of. Thank you for considering my interest and rationale this request.

Smith, Jenie

EASTPORT

Despite my profound disappointment at the demise of Mr. Platner's campaign, I felt a faint but familiar burst of hope in him, in a candidate that reminded us of our fundamental principles that government is of, for, and by The People of Maine, and of The *United* States. Ms. Collins is no longer a true representative but rather a bought pawn, voting at the hands of billionaire backers and cow-towing to the whims of President Trump. This particular Senate race may be the most important in my lifetime. I have felt disillusioned by The System for a number of election cycles, but I am hopeful now, because of what we all witnessed during other candidates' campaigns, that active participation will remind me that our Government, both State and Federal, remains composed of We the People...*IF* we show up.

Smith-Marengo, Beatricia

ADDISON

My name is Bea Smith-Marengo of Addison, Washington County Maine. I'm looking to be a Delegate to have a voice for myself and my family, My siblings and I all have varying health issues since birth. I'd like to have voice in choosing the right person who can speak on our behalf. We need to elect someone who is familiar with the needs of the handicapped and disabled. The candidate I support must have empathy, and billing to fight for those who cannot fight for themselves. My family needs healthcare, not million spent on a ballroom. We don't need more soldiers coming home with PTSD from fighting stupid wars. We need to care for the ones we do have instead tax cuts to billionaires. I appreciate your support and will represent you well in Bangor in choosing candidate who works for the "We the People." Sincerely yours, Bea Smith Marengo

Steslow, Frank

MILBRIDGE

As perhaps the most consequential election in 250 years of this Democracy, November's Senatorial election will either cement the Supreme Court as a conservative super majority for decades or with Democratic control won, have the possibility of beginning to reverse the extensive damage. I want to do everything I can to see this reversal with the defeat of Susan Collins. I'm a small business owner, national education nonprofit CEO and Washington County resident. I see clearly what's happening and I will champion candidates that are willing to stand up and push for a progressive agenda including higher taxes for ultra wealthy, universal healthcare and standing against genocide as well as the unbelievable corruption of this administration. I will fully support the outcome of the process and support the candidate financially and with the time and energy I can offer between now and November. Thank you.

Venuti, Edward

ROBBINSON

I am a 72 year old resident of Robbinston, Maine I am very interested in being a delegate for this democratic convention. I would love the opportunity to exercise my rights before our Constitutional Rights are further stripped from our nation. As a resident of a rural town in Washington County I can provide a unique perspective. I care deeply about the future of our democracy. Thank you so much for your consideration.

Weitz, Bradley

CUTLER

I am seeking to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I bring a perspective that is too often missing from political decision-making: the day-to-day reality of caring for children and families in rural Maine. As the only pediatrician in Washington County, I see firsthand how policy decisions made in Augusta and Washington directly shape the health, stability, and future of our communities. I want to ensure that rural families and children have a strong voice in our party's priorities and leadership. To help defeat Susan Collins in November, I will volunteer in coordinated campaign efforts, support voter registration and turnout, and use my trusted role in the community to counter misinformation with real, lived experiences. Our strength as a party comes from people who are rooted in their communities. I am ready to bring that voice to the convention and beyond.

Zaengle, Frederick

WHITING

I have been involved in local Democratic politics most of my adult life. I was a township committee man in Pennsylvania for several years, a member of the teachers union for 16 years. I am interested in helping elect strong honest people interested in making Maine a better place for all to live.